

Natural features directly determine where people live by controlling access to essential resources like food, water, and shelter.

Quick Reference: Natural Factors & Settlement

Feature	High Population Density (Dense)	Low Population Density (Sparse)
Landforms	Flat plains & lowlands: Easy to build houses, roads, and farms.	Steep mountains: Hard to construct infrastructure and farm.
Climate	Temperate zones: Mild temperatures and reliable rainfall for farming.	Extreme zones: Deserts (too dry) or Polar regions (too cold).
Water	Rivers & lakes: Vital for drinking, farming, and transport.	Drylands & swamps: Too little fresh water or risk of severe flooding.
Soil	Fertile soil: Deep, rich soil (river valleys) produces food for large populations.	Poor soil: Thin, sandy, or frozen soil (permafrost) limits farming.

Key Terms to Remember

- Dense Population: Many people living in a small area (e.g., coastal plains, river banks).
- Sparse Population: Few people spread over a large area (e.g., high mountains, deserts).
- Adaptation: How humans change their lifestyle to survive in difficult physical environments.

References (MLA 9th Edition)

- de Blij, Harm J., et al. *Human Geography: People, Place, and Culture*. 11th ed., Wiley, 2014.
- Rubenstein, James M. *The Cultural Landscape: An Introduction to Human Geography*. 13th ed., Pearson, 2019.